

Alastor Curns

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INTRODUCTION

Engineering leader with 9+ years, promoted from project engineer to principal, currently leading a team of 5. Grew from hands-on developer to setting technical direction and delivering the company's modern core products. Balance technical leadership with hiring, mentorship, and cross-functional delivery across design, product, sales, and engineering.

EXPERIENCE

CodeMettle

Atlanta, GA

Principal Engineer

2023 - Present

- **Leadership:** Lead a team of 5, advocating for engineers and influencing executive leadership on technical strategy and investment. Balance technical direction with people development, hiring, and product priorities.
- **Delivery & AI:** Led the team's adoption of AI-assisted, test-driven development (Claude Code, MCP servers, custom skills), halving ticket-to-PR time and raising test coverage from 60% to 90% while keeping delivery on pace. Moved code review and e2e testing into CI; the team fully adopted the workflow within 3 months.

Lead Software Engineer

2020 - 2023

- **Lead:** Set engineering direction and coordinated across engineering and product to design and deliver the roadmap and system architecture.
- **Deliver:** Led the rewrite of the legacy Java/Play application into a modern Node.js/TypeScript stack, porting all services. Shipped high-quality systems, maintained a Scala/Java polling service, and guided design of complex graph structures, concurrency, and reusable patterns.
- **Mentor:** Authored onboarding documentation and mentored engineers, cutting onboarding time from roughly a week to 1–3 days.

Systems Engineer

2017-2020

- **Fullstack Environment:** Built services, backend logic, APIs, and visualizations across multiple stacks under tight deadlines. Bridged product, design, integrators, and end users as the engineering point of contact.
- **Travel (~30%):** Visited global customer sites to prototype, demonstrate features, and serve as the engineering subject-matter expert.

Project Engineer

August 2016-2017

- **Project Lead:** Led a team of 3–5 developers to deploy production-ready systems to customers.
- **Hardware Integration:** Translated live satellite-infrastructure data into well-defined databases in Python.

PROJECTS

Polling Backend: Architected asynchronous subprocesses in a Node.js backend to ingest device data across protocols (SSH, SNMP, HTTP, streaming, serial, TCP, UDP, and WebSocket), scaling from 10–50 devices (hundreds of changes/sec) to ~500 devices (thousands of changes/sec) in production.

Flows: Developed a domain-specific language and event-driven architecture that let users define secure polls, data transformation/validation, and rules.

Data Visualizations: Built geographical and logical network graphs (D3, MapBox, cytoscape.js, React Flow) rendering hundreds of nodes/edges across 4–5 datasources: tx/rx, alarms, OSPF/BGP changes, and geospatial. Wrote Grafana datasource plugins for Apache Solr and MongoDB.

Network Infrastructure: Created Cisco IOS and Juniper configurations and automation to manage the office network stack and stand up test scenarios for QA.

FIPS: Built an optional FIPS-compliant mode enforcing BouncyCastle in Java and compiling Node and Go binaries against FIPS crypto chains.

SKILLS

Leadership: Team building, hiring, mentorship, roadmap & delivery, cross-functional collaboration, Agile

Languages & Libraries: TypeScript, Python, Java, Bash, C, HTML/CSS/JS, Effect-TS, Express, Vite, Gulp

Technologies & Frameworks: Node.js, React, Jest, SNMP, Linux, OpenAPI, REST, MongoDB, MUI, Docker, Electron

Methods: Git, Neovim, OOP, Functional/Immutable patterns, CI/CD, Claude Code, Snyk, Trivy, Obsidian, Monorepo

EDUCATION

Georgia State University

Atlanta, GA

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science; Dean's List; GPA: 3.43

Graduated May 2015